



AUGUST 31–SEPTEMBER 6, 2026

20

SONG 89 Listen, Obey, and Be Blessed

Pay Attention to How You Listen

“Pay attention to how you listen.”—[LUKE 8:18](#).

FOCUS

Why we need to keep listening attentively during meetings and other spiritual programs and how we can do so.

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

Accept

Decline

Customize

spiritual programs include material that has been covered many times, do you find it hard to pay attention? This article can help you. We will consider why we need to listen carefully at meetings. We will also see how those who teach in the congregation can help others to listen. And we will discuss some suggestions that can help us become better listeners. But first, let us examine who is speaking to us.

REMEMBER THAT JEHOVAH IS SPEAKING TO US

3. How does Jehovah speak to us, and how do his servants make good use of his Word?

³ Jehovah speaks to us by means of his Word, the Bible. ([2 Tim. 3:16, 17](#)) Jesus understood this. He used God's Word so skillfully that his listeners were moved to ask: "How does this man have such a knowledge of the Scriptures when he has not studied at the schools?"

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

⁴ The words “hear” and “listen” are often used in the Bible to convey the idea of obeying someone. Therefore, when Jehovah speaks to us by means of his Word at our meetings and we come to understand what his will is, it is easier to obey him. We can trust that Jehovah is pleased when we listen to him and act accordingly.—[Prov. 27:11](#).

WHY SHOULD WE LISTEN CAREFULLY AT MEETINGS?

5. What does our love for Jehovah move us to do? ([John 4:23, 24](#); [1 John 5:3](#))

⁵ ***We listen at meetings because we love Jehovah.*** ([Matt. 22:37](#)) The more we learn about Jehovah, the more our love for him grows. That love stirs in us the desire to listen to him, to obey him, and to worship him in the way he has set out in his Word.—**Read** [John 4:23, 24](#); [1 John 5:3](#)

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

⁷ We listen at meetings because we love life. Obeying God's Word means life for us, as it did for true worshippers in the past. ([Deut. 32:44-47](#)) By listening at our meetings, we receive the encouragement we need to keep on waiting with endurance for the new world to come. ([Rom. 8:25](#)) Listening to Jehovah now is vital because we are in the last days and must stay spiritually alert.—[Matt. 24:42-44](#); [Rev. 1:3](#).

HOW TO HELP OTHERS TO LISTEN AT MEETINGS

8. Why should brothers who teach from the platform continue to improve in their speaking ability?

⁸ Brothers who teach from the platform, especially those who give

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

⁹ Prepare a clear structure. As a speaker, you want your material to be easy to follow. The audience may become distracted if the material is too complicated. What can you do to give a well-structured talk? Here are some steps: (1) Try to make it clear at the outset what your main points will be. (2) Cover these points one at a time, pausing between main points and clearly stating the next main point before moving on. (3) Briefly review the points in your conclusion.

10. Why is it important to get excited about the material?

¹⁰ Get excited about the material. You will speak with enthusiasm if you develop points **you** love. ([Prov. 2:4, 5; Acts 4:20](#)) Meditating on the scriptures and the assigned material will help you find these points. A brother from the United States who is in his 70's recalls a talk he heard when he was in his teens: "I still remember how the speaker encouraged us to meditate deeply when reading God's Word. He

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

Ephesus. (**Read [1 Timothy 4:13-16](#).**) Think about what your listeners need, and help them to see practical ways that they can apply the information in their life.

12. Why is it best to speak naturally when giving a talk?

12 Practice your talk out loud so that you can speak in a conversational manner. When you speak naturally instead of writing out your talk word for word and reading it, those in the audience will find it easier to listen and absorb the information. The brochure *Apply Yourself to Reading and Teaching* says: “Speak in a natural, sincere way that conveys how you feel about the topic and your listeners.” As you speak from the heart, your audience will find your delivery more lively, interesting, and motivating.

13. Why should teachers in the congregation ask experienced speakers for counsel?
(See also picture.)

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).



Ask an experienced speaker to help you improve as a teacher (See paragraph 13)

HOW TO BECOME A BETTER LISTENER

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

15 We need to maintain a positive view of the spiritual food we receive, just as the Israelites should have maintained a positive view of Jehovah's provision of the manna when they were in the wilderness. ([Ex. 16:15, 31](#)) No doubt the Israelites at first appreciated the manna. It came from Jehovah, it tasted good, and it sustained their life. In time, however, some grew tired of eating manna every day. ([Num. 21:5](#)) The lesson? We must never view the spiritual food we receive as commonplace or needlessly repetitive. But instead, we need to recognize that Jehovah is the Source. We must remember that it is thoughtfully prepared by Jehovah's organization. We should also reflect on the reality that the wisdom we gain from it can preserve our life.—[Prov. 3:13, 16-18; John 17:3](#).

16. What has helped some longtime servants of Jehovah to keep listening attentively at meetings? (See also the box "[Tips for Listening Well](#).")

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

Tips for Listening Well

When asked, “What helps you listen attentively at meetings,” longtime servants of Jehovah shared the following tips:

- Suefawn, baptized in 1986, says, “Sit up front at the Kingdom Hall to stay focused on the speaker and the videos.”
- David, baptized in 1983, says, “I pray many times to Jehovah to help me concentrate, and I remind myself that attending, concentrating, and participating are all part of my worship.”
- Nicolas, baptized in 1982, says, “Have the objective of thanking each person on the program for a specific example, idea, or illustration that you enjoyed about his part.”
- Augustin, baptized in 1988, says, “I always tell myself that if the faithful slave has planned to revisit a topic, it is spiritual food at

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

focused on the speaker. (6) Take brief notes, or make simple drawings of key points. (7) Try to think about the key scriptures and the logical order in which they are presented. (8) Ask yourself, 'How can I use this to help someone in the congregation or in the territory?' (9) At assemblies and conventions, preview the day's theme, the subjects to be presented, and the key scriptures for each talk. (10) Prepare your heart by sitting quietly and paying attention to the music and video presentations that are played at the start of the program.



Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

18 We should keep listening at meetings because by doing so, we allow Jehovah to lead us in “the paths of righteousness.” ([Ps. 23:3; 31:3](#)) We need the corrective counsel we receive so that we will not drift off course like a boat driven off course by the wind. Therefore, “pay attention to how you listen” and apply the guidance you receive at congregation meetings. ([Luke 8:18](#)) Those who listen to Jehovah will be happy now and have everlasting life in the future.—[Ps. 119:2, 14](#).

HOW WOULD YOU ANSWER?

- Why should we listen at meetings?

- How can brothers who teach at meetings help others to listen?

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).

[Copyright](#) © 2026 Watch Tower Bible and Tract Society of Pennsylvania.

Privacy Settings

To provide you with the best possible experience, we use cookies and similar technologies. Some cookies are necessary to make our website work and cannot be refused. You can accept or decline the use of additional cookies, which we use only to improve your experience. None of this data will ever be sold or used for marketing. To learn more, read the [Global Policy on Use of Cookies and Similar Technologies](#). You can customize your settings at any time by going to [Privacy Settings](#).